

Acme Corp — Employee Handbook

Version 3.2 | Effective Date: 1 January 2025

1. Company Overview

Acme Corp was founded in 1998 and is headquartered in Sheffield, United Kingdom. The company employs approximately 2,400 people across twelve offices worldwide. Our primary business lines are enterprise software development, cloud infrastructure services, and AI-powered analytics platforms. Acme Corp is publicly listed on the London Stock Exchange under the ticker symbol ACME.

2. Mission and Values

Our mission is to deliver reliable, scalable software solutions that help businesses operate more efficiently. We are guided by four core values: integrity in all interactions, relentless focus on quality, respect for every individual, and commitment to sustainable growth.

3. Working Hours and Flexible Working

Standard working hours are 9:00 to 17:30, Monday to Friday, with a 30-minute unpaid lunch break. All employees are eligible for the FlexTime programme after completing three months of continuous employment. Under FlexTime, core hours are 10:00 to 15:00; employees may adjust their start and finish times within a window of 07:00 to 19:00 provided their manager approves the arrangement in writing.

4. Annual Leave Entitlement

Full-time employees receive 25 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, rising to 28 days after five years of continuous service. Leave must be booked at least five working days in advance and is subject to manager approval. A maximum of five days may be carried over into the following calendar year; any remainder is forfeited. The company observes all UK public holidays in addition to the contractual entitlement.

5. Employee Benefits

Benefit	Details	Eligibility
Private Medical Insurance	AXA PPP Healthcare, family cover available	From day one
Pension Scheme	6% employer contribution, 4% employee minimum	From day one
Life Assurance	4x annual salary	From day one
Cycle to Work	Up to GBP 1,000 tax-free bike purchase	After 3 months
Gym Subsidy	GBP 40/month reimbursed via expenses	After 3 months
Learning Budget	GBP 1,500/year for courses and conferences	After 6 months
Share Save Scheme	Options at 20% discount on market price	After 1 year

6. Return and Refund Policy

Acme Corp offers a 30-day return policy on all hardware products purchased directly through the company store. Items must be returned in their original packaging and in an undamaged, unused condition. Software licences are non-refundable once the product key has been activated. To initiate a return, customers must contact the support team at returns@acmecorp.com with the order number and reason for return. Refunds are processed within 7 to 10 business days to the original payment method.

7. Remote Working Policy

Employees may work remotely for up to three days per week following successful completion of their probationary period (six months). Remote working arrangements must be documented in an approved Remote Working Agreement. Employees are responsible for maintaining a safe, ergonomic workspace and must be reachable via Slack and email during their agreed working hours. The company provides a one-time GBP 300 home-office equipment allowance for eligible remote workers.

8. IT Security Policy

All employees must complete mandatory information-security training within the first two weeks of joining. Company laptops must have full-disk encryption enabled and must connect to the corporate VPN when accessing internal systems from outside the office. Passwords must be at least 16 characters long, must not be reused within the last 12 cycles, and must be stored in the approved password manager (1Password). Employees must never share credentials or leave devices unattended in public places. Suspected security incidents must be reported immediately to security@acmecorp.com.

9. Disciplinary Procedure

The disciplinary procedure exists to ensure fair and consistent handling of conduct or performance concerns. The stages are: (1) informal discussion with line manager, (2) formal verbal warning, (3) first written warning, (4) final written warning, (5) dismissal. In cases of gross misconduct — including harassment, fraud, or serious data breaches — the company reserves the right to proceed directly to dismissal without following earlier stages. Employees have the right to be accompanied by a colleague or trade union representative at any formal stage of the process.

10. Expense Reimbursement

Business expenses must be submitted via the Concur expense system within 30 days of being incurred. All claims above GBP 25 require a receipt. Meals during business travel are reimbursed at up to GBP 40 per day (breakfast GBP 10, lunch GBP 12, dinner GBP 18). Alcohol is not reimbursable as a standalone item. Hotel accommodation is capped at GBP 180 per night in London and GBP 120 per night elsewhere in the UK. International travel must be pre-approved by a Director.

11. Parental Leave

Acme Corp offers enhanced parental leave above the statutory minimum. Primary carers are entitled to 26 weeks at full pay followed by 13 weeks at statutory pay. Secondary carers are entitled to four weeks at full pay. Shared parental leave is available and can be split flexibly between eligible parents. Employees must give at least eight weeks' written notice of the intended leave start date.

12. Frequently Asked Questions

How do I book annual leave?

Log into Workday, navigate to Time Off, select the dates, choose 'Annual Leave' as the leave type, and submit for manager approval. You will receive an email confirmation once the request is approved or declined.

What is the probationary period?

The standard probationary period is six months. During this time, either party may terminate employment with one week's notice. Performance is formally reviewed at the three-month and six-month marks.

Who do I contact about payroll queries?

All payroll queries should be directed to payroll@acmecorp.com. Please include your employee ID and the relevant pay period in the subject line. Responses are typically provided within two business days.

Can I work from a location outside the UK?

Working from overseas for more than 15 days in a rolling 12-month period requires prior approval from HR and your department head due to tax and employment law implications. Short trips of up to 15 days are permitted with manager approval only.

How do I raise a grievance?

In the first instance, try to resolve the issue informally with your line manager. If that is not possible, submit a written grievance to hr@acmecorp.com. HR will acknowledge receipt within two working days and arrange a meeting within five.

What is the notice period for resignation?

Notice periods depend on length of service: less than 1 year — 4 weeks; 1 to 5 years — 8 weeks; over 5 years — 12 weeks. Your contract of employment takes precedence if it specifies a longer period.

This handbook is reviewed annually. Last reviewed: December 2024. For the latest version visit the HR portal at hr.acmecorp.internal.